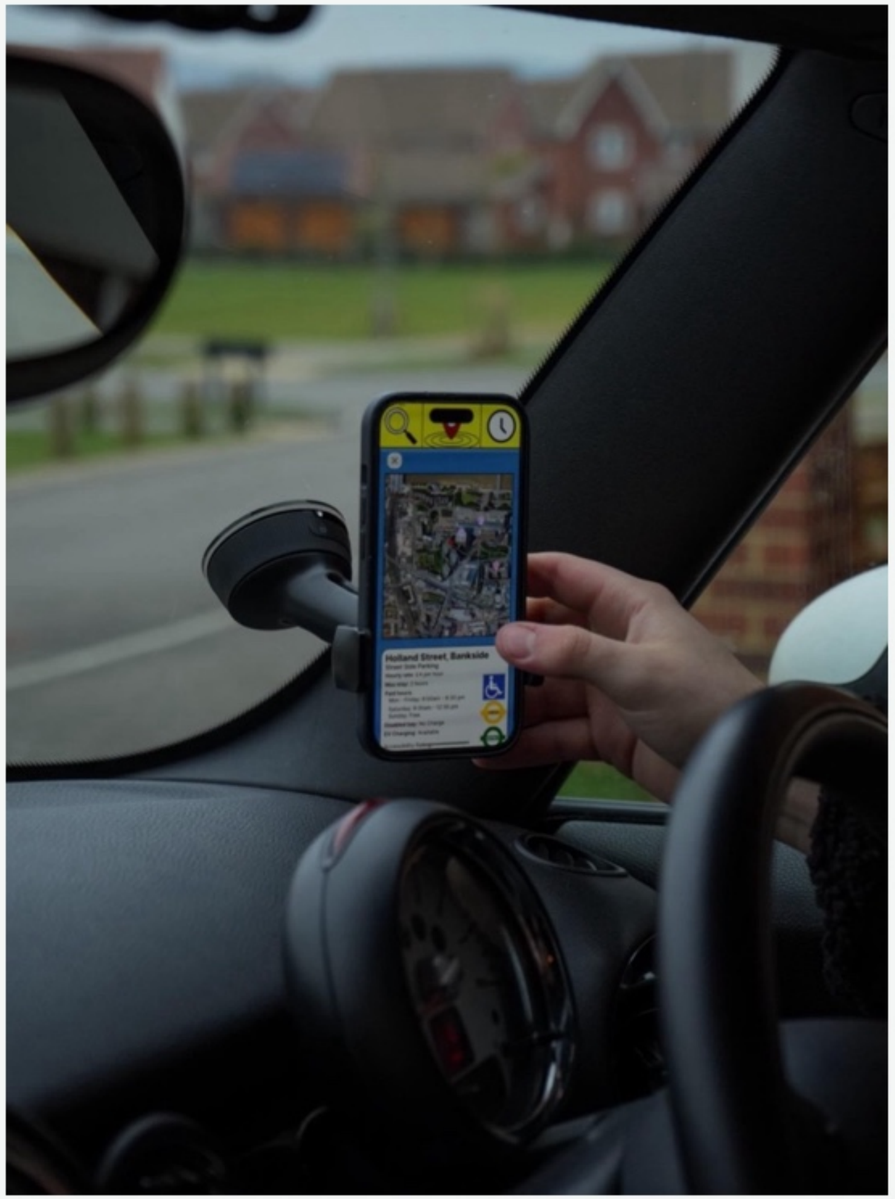


ParkIt – City Parking

Community-Driven Urban Mobility & Accessible Blue Badge Navigation

The universal city parking app designed to maximise urban parking efficiency and promote Blue Badge accessibility. Built around community-verified street bays, transparent hourly rates, and onward public transport links rather than expensive corporate car parks.

Discipline

UI/UX & Urban Mobility

Context

UAL Foundation Brief

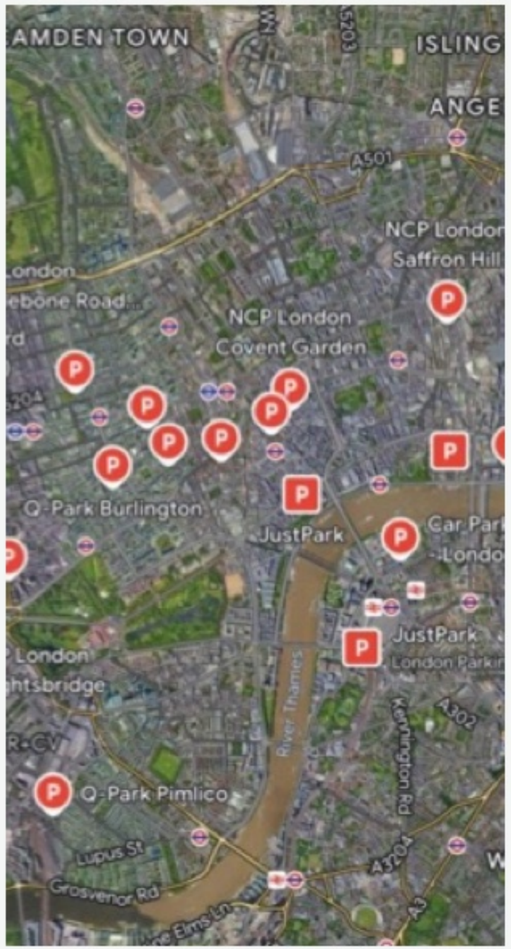
Tools

Field Audit, Wireframing, UI

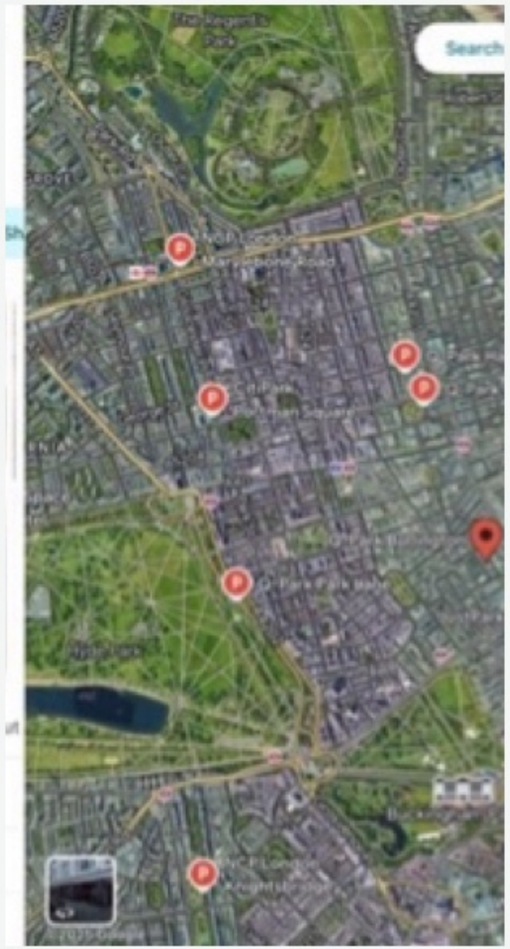
Outcome

A high-contrast, UK road-signage-inspired mobile interface informed by a walked primary field survey of London's Southbank and designed for drivers of all ages.

Research part 1 — corporate car park bias on digital maps







The Corporate Navigation Blind Spot

When motorists or Blue Badge holders search 'Parking in London' or 'Disabled Parking in London' on mainstream navigation apps, the results are dominated by high-tariff commercial multi-storey operators (NCP, Q-Park, APCOA).

Hundreds of legal council street-side bays and free Blue Badge spaces remain completely invisible on digital maps.

Fig. 01–03 — Searching 'Parking in London' and 'Disabled Parking in London' on Google Maps only surfaces expensive corporate car parks (NCP, Q-Park)

Research part 2 — walked Southbank primary survey



Fig. 04 — Walked primary survey route from Waterloo to Tate Modern (lined in red)

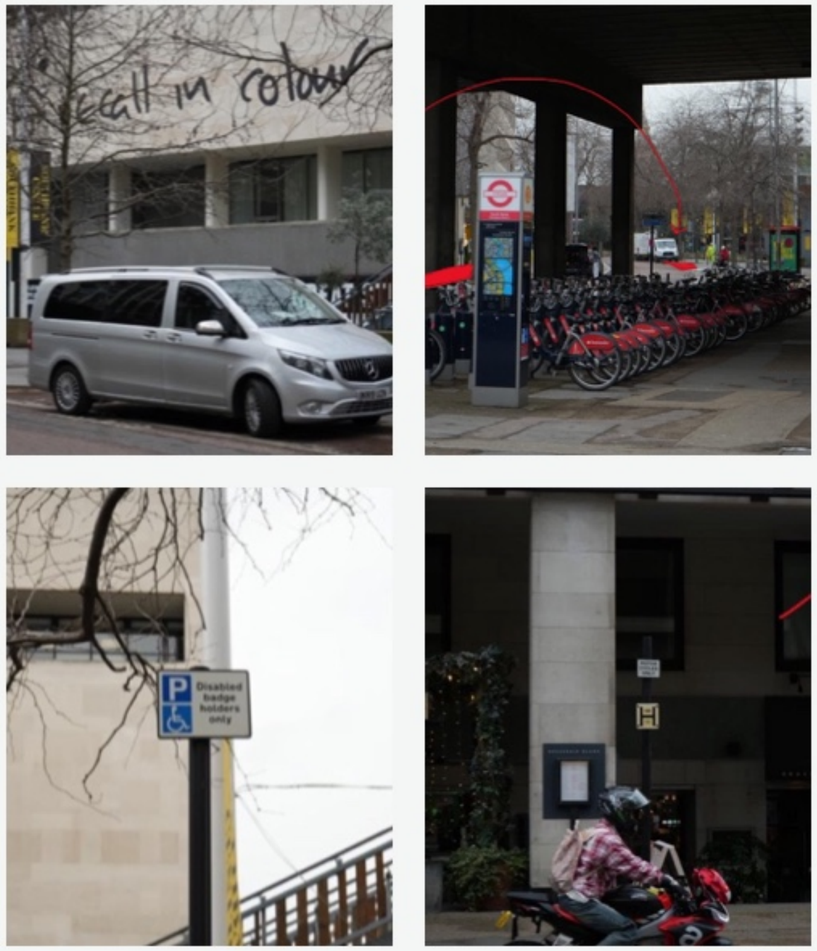
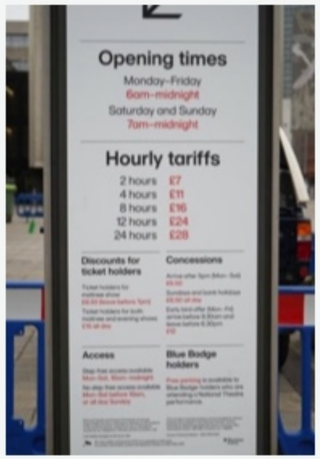


Fig. 05–08 — Unmapped disabled bays (no time limit) behind Royal Festival Hall & Santander cycle links

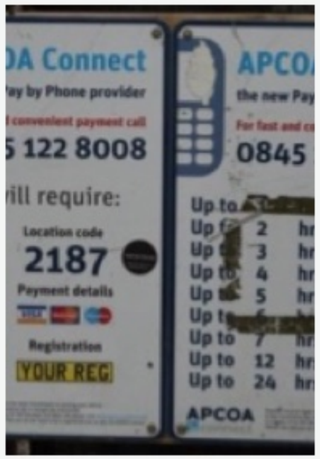
Ground-Truth Field Audit

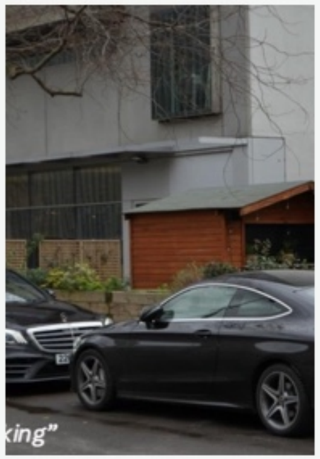
To test digital maps against physical reality, I walked a central route through Southbank to Tate Modern (marked in red) and photographed every street-side bay, tariff board, and onward Santander cycle dock.

Research part 3 — street-side signage & tariff audit

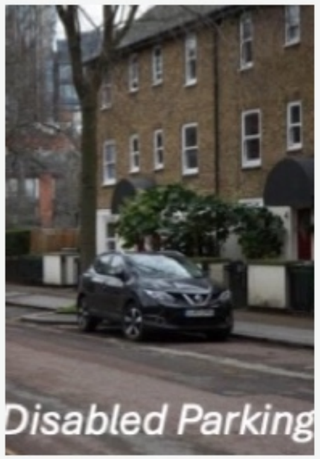


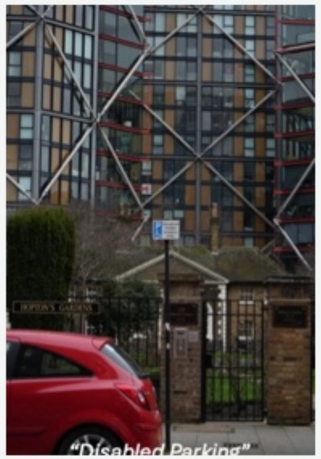


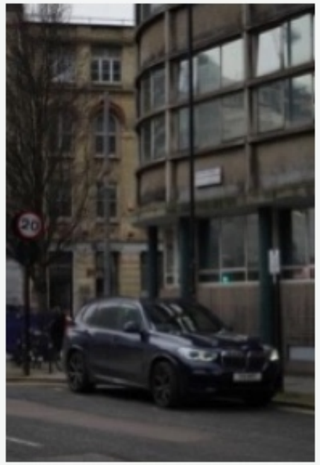








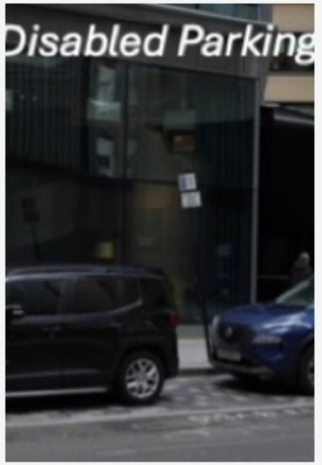


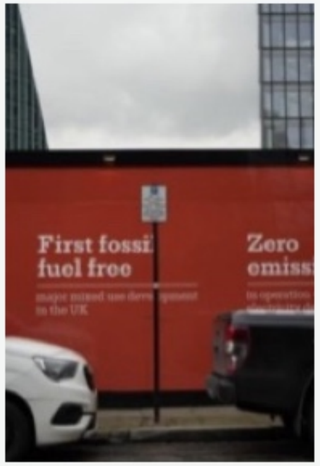












13 Unmapped Bays

Every single disabled bay and pay-by-phone street bay photographed here along Upper Ground, Coin St, and Bear Lane was absent from Google Maps.

Fig. 09–21 — Complete street-side photographic audit along Southbank documenting bay capacity, RingGo/PayByPhone tariffs, and Blue Badge exemptions

Research part 4 — satellite pin audit & competitor apps



Fig. 22 — Southbank satellite audit: Blue pins = unmapped Disabled Parking bays · Red pins = unmapped Paid Street Parking bays

1 Commercial Lot vs Dozens of Street Bays

Across my entire walked Southbank route, Google Maps displayed only 1 commercial car park (APCOA Cornwall Road) with zero Blue Badge street visibility.

Every blue pin (Disabled Bay) and red pin (Paid Street Bay) plotted on Fig. 22 was physically verified on the street.

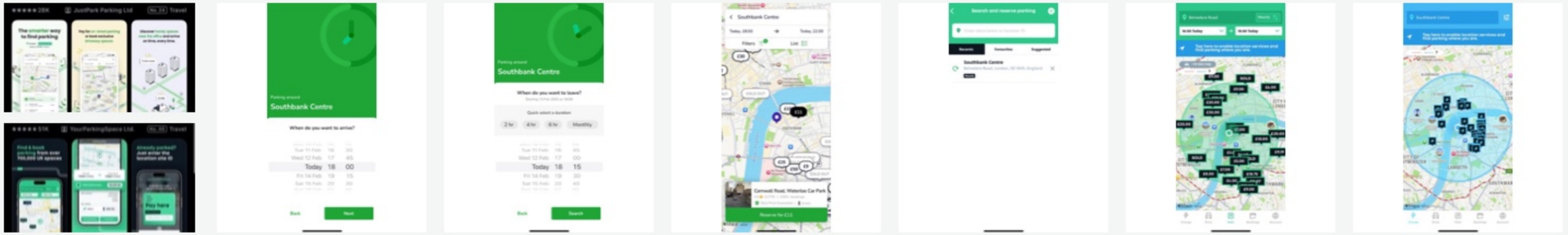


Fig. 23–30 — Competitor app audit (JustPark & YourParkingSpace): multi-screen pre-booking friction and private driveway bias

Ideation part 1 — feature, function & accessibility mindmap

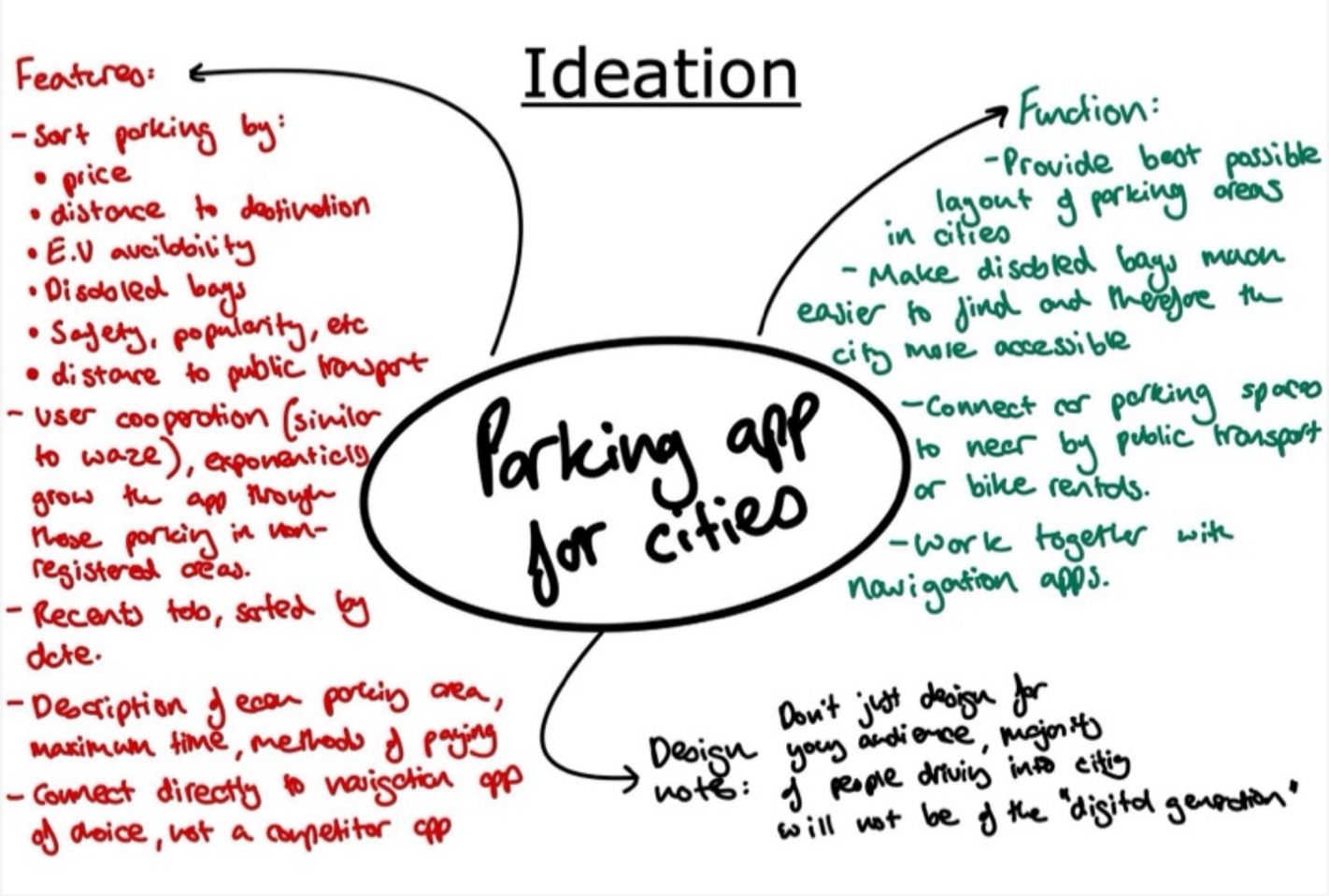


Fig. 31 — Initial feature, function, and visual identity mindmap establishing community bay submission and SMS verification

Designing for Real Drivers, Not Just 'Digital Natives'

Because motorists span every age group from 17 to 85+, the app architecture avoids hidden gestures or complex pre-booking calendars:

01 **Strictly Three Top Tabs** — Search (magnifying glass), Drop a Bay Pin (map pin), and Recent Locations (clock)—always visible at the top of the screen.

02 **Anti-Spoofing SMS Verification** — Users verify with a mobile phone number rather than disposable email addresses so commercial car parks cannot spoof ratings.

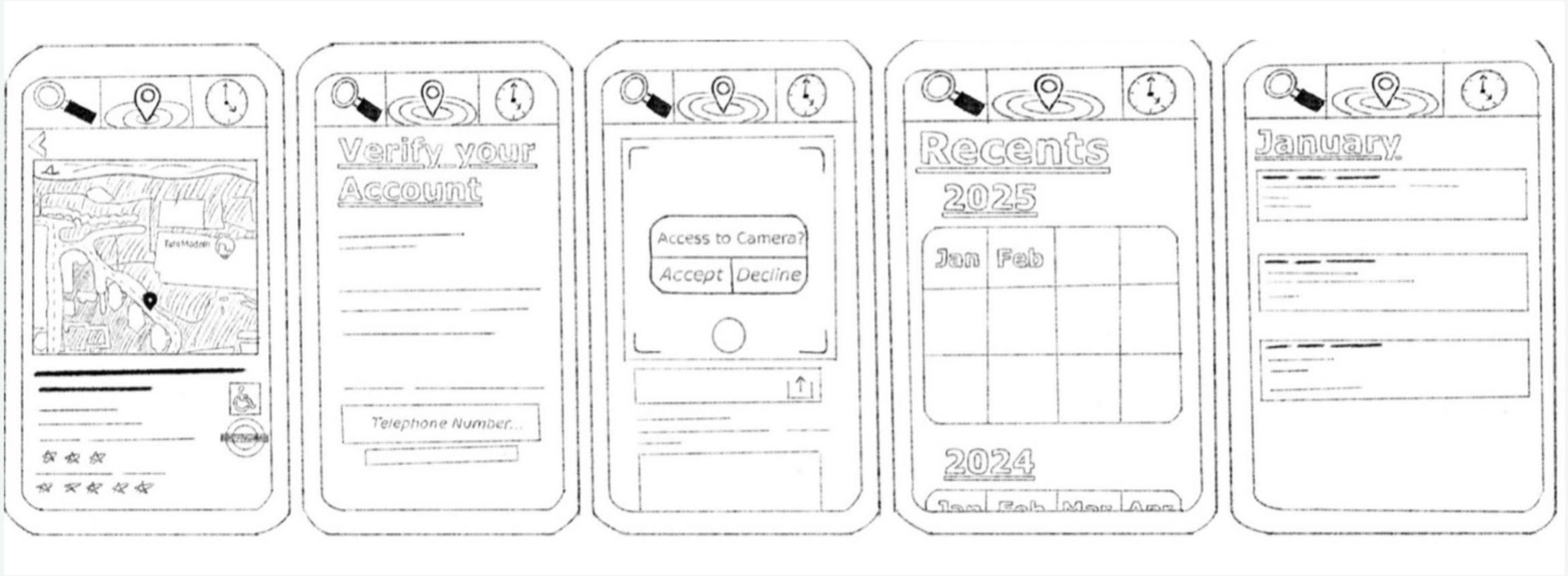
03 **Public Transport Integration** — Displays nearest Tube lines and Santander cycle docks beside each parking bay for last-mile city travel.

Ideation part 2 — wireframes: city search, sorting & map view



Screen 01 — Splash	Screen 02 — City Select	Screen 03 — Area Tariff List	Screen 04 — Sort & Filter	Screen 05 — Bay Detail Map
Iconic UK 'P' road sign entry screen	**Select default UK city (changeable anytime)**	Ranks street bays by hourly tariff (£4–£15/h)	Filter by Disabled Bays, popularity & Tube proximity	Satellite pin view with Blue Badge & Tube icons

Ideation part 3 — wireframes: camera bay upload & calendar recents



Screen 06 — Camera Access	Screen 07 — Submit Bay	Screen 08 — SMS Verify	Screen 09 — Recents by Year	Screen 10 — Recents by Date
Prompts camera permission to photograph street sign	**User tags bay tariff, max stay & Blue Badge rules**	Phone number verification prevents bot spam	Groups past parking sessions by Year & Month	Recalls exact street bay used on a specific date

Visual development — UK road-signage colour blocking



Signage-Inspired Chromatic Hierarchy

The colour palette directly mirrors British 'P' parking signage. To guarantee instant glanceability inside a car, only section headers use white lettering on blue, while all tariff data, street names, and filter controls use high-contrast black type on white or yellow.

Fig. 42–46 — First full-colour digital wireframes translating hand sketches into British parking-signage blue, yellow, white, and black

Final interface design — high-resolution iOS screens

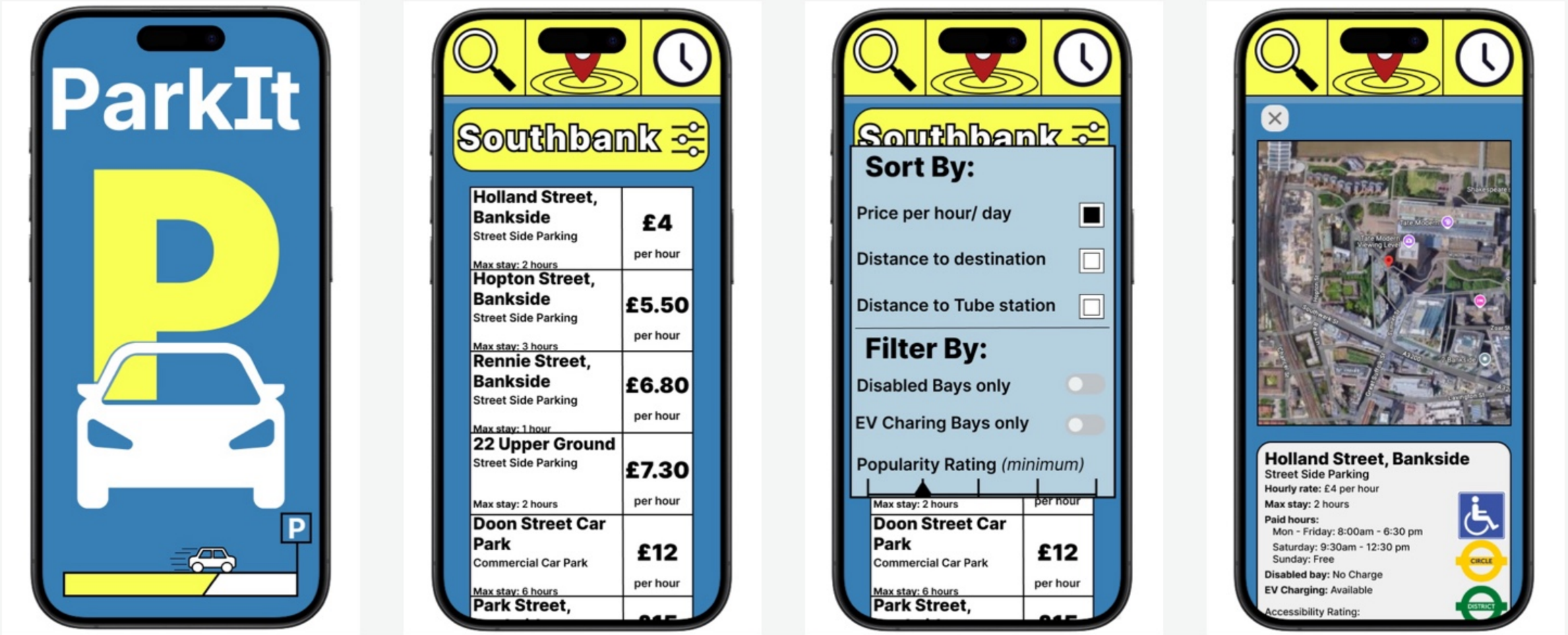


Fig. 47–50 — Final ParkIt iOS interface: (1) Launch Screen, (2) Southbank Hourly Tariff List (£4–£12/hr), (3) Sort & Filter Overlay (Disabled & EV Bays), and (4) Holland Street Bay Detail View